

CAPTION STYLE GUIDE

Most social video is watched with the sound off. Captions are part of the design.

THE 4 STYLES

STYLE	LOOKS LIKE	USE FOR	DEFAULT SIZE
pop	1-3 BIG words, active word highlighted	Reels, TikTok, Shorts	~12% of width
karaoke	a line fills with colour as spoken	quotes, lyrics, hooks	~8%
clean	sentence subtitles on a soft box	YouTube, interviews, courses	~5%
minimal	small outlined subtitles	brand films, cinematic	~4%

RULES

- Never cover eyes or mouth. Position around 65–70% down the frame on vertical video.
- Keep clear of the platform UI: **top 250 px, bottom 420 px, right 140 px** (9:16).
- Highlight **emphasis words** (numbers, promises, emotions) in the accent colour, 1–3 per sentence.
- Pop captions: UPPERCASE, no trailing commas or full stops.
- Clean subtitles: sentence case, max 2 lines, max ~42 characters per line.
- Spell names right (fix the transcript first).
- Always also export the `.srt` file for YouTube/LinkedIn (accessibility + search).

PROMPTS

- "Pop captions, brand colours, highlight free, secret, 10x."
- "Captions one size smaller and 10% higher."
- "Clean subtitles for the YouTube version and give me the .srt."

DIRECT THE VIBE. LET AI DO THE KEYFRAMES.

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